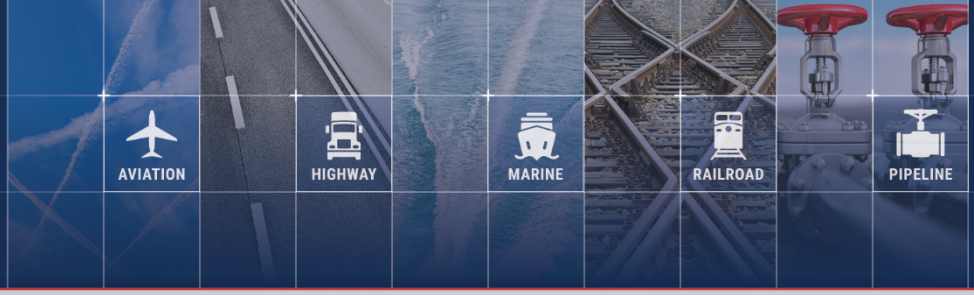

Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Anchorage, Alaska	**Accident Number:**	ANC25LA014
Date & Time:	December 31, 2024, 13:30 Local	**Registration:**	N3552E
Aircraft:	Cessna 172N	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:	Loss of control on ground	**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Instructional		

Analysis

The student pilot reported that, after performing her first solo landing while conducting touch-and-go landings on an ice-covered runway, she inadvertently allowed the airplane to veer to the left of runway centerline while reconfiguring the airplane for takeoff. The student pilot reported overcorrecting with right rudder and while attempting to correct the overcorrection by applying left rudder, she inadvertently applied the left brake, resulting in a loss of directional control. The airplane exited the runway surface and nosed over which resulted in substantial damage to the vertical stabilizer, rudder, right aileron, right lift strut, and right wing. The pilot reported that there were no preaccident mechanical failures or malfunctions with the airplane that would have precluded normal operation.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The student pilot’s failure to maintain directional control of the airplane during touch-and-go operations on an ice-covered runway during her first solo flight.

Findings

Personnel issues	Aircraft control - Student/instructed pilot
Environmental issues	Snow/slush/ice covered surface - Contributed to outcome
Aircraft	Directional control - Not attained/maintained

Factual Information

History of Flight

Takeoff	Loss of control on ground (Defining event)

Student pilot Information

Certificate:	Student	**Age:**	45,Female
Airplane Rating(s):	None	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 1 Without waivers/limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	September 24, 2024
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	27 hours (Total, all aircraft), 27 hours (Total, this make and model), 0 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 27 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 17 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 2 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	**Registration:**	N3552E
Model/Series:	172N	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	1978	**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	17271584
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	November 20, 2024 100 hour	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2300 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:	69.3 Hrs	**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	13676.2 Hrs as of last inspection	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Avco Lycoming
ELT:	Not installed	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320-D2J
Registered Owner:	ANGEL AVIATION INC	**Rated Power:**	160 Horsepower
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	Pilot school (141)

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	PAMR,126 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	0 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	12:53 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	271°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	/	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	None / None
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	N/A / N/A
Altimeter Setting:	30.16 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	-9°C / -12°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Anchorage, AK	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Anchorage, AK	**Type of Clearance:**	VFR
Departure Time:		**Type of Airspace:**	Class D

Airport Information

Airport:	Merrill Field MRI	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	137 ft msl	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Ice
Runway Used:	25	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	4000 ft / 100 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Touch and go

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:		**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	61.215714,-149.84268

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Rasmussen, Mitchell
Additional Participating Persons:	Patrick Teagarden; FAA - FSDO; Anchorage, AK
Original Publish Date:	May 12, 2025
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199498

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.